

	Division/Section	Family Support
	Chapter No./Name	4 – Economic Stability (ES)
	Part No./Name	C – Case Processing
	Section No./Name	C-1300-FITAP-SNAP Cooperation
	Document No./Name	C-1310-SNAP Cooperation Requirements
	Effective Date	January 1, 2023

I. STATEMENT OF POLICY

THE CLIENT MUST COOPERATE IN THE PROCESS OF DETERMINING ELIGIBILITY BY COMPLETING AN APPLICATION, BEING INTERVIEWED if required, AND PROVIDING REQUIRED INFORMATION.

DO NOT ASK THE CLIENT TO PROVIDE INFORMATION WHICH IS CLEARLY IMPOSSIBLE TO SECURE, SUCH AS CHECK STUBS FOR A CLIENT WHO IS PAID IN CASH OR THE ADDRESS OF A PERSON THE CLIENT CANNOT LOCATE.

IF THE WORKER HAS FULFILLED HIS RESPONSIBILITIES, BUT THE CLIENT FAILS TO PROVIDE INFORMATION HE AGREED TO PROVIDE WHICH IS NECESSARY TO COMPLETE THE ELIGIBILITY DETERMINATION PROCESS, TAKE ACTION TO DENY THE APPLICATION OR CLOSE THE CASE USING ADVERSE ACTION PROCEDURE.

C-1311-SNAP - PO APPLICATIONS

TIMELY SCHEDULE AN APPLICATION APPOINTMENT.

C-1312-SNAP - PO REDETERMINATIONS

IF THE HOUSEHOLD FAILS TO SUBMIT A TIMELY REAPPLICATION, CLOSE THE CASE ON THE DAY AFTER THE TIMELY REAPPLICATION DUE DATE.

C-1313-SNAP - PO OTHER ELIGIBILITY REVIEWS

THE HOUSEHOLD MUST COOPERATE IN ANY SUBSEQUENT REVIEW OF ITS ELIGIBILITY, INCLUDING REVIEWS GENERATED BY:

- REPORTED CHANGES, or
- as part of a Quality Control (QC) or Federal Quality Control (QC) review.

If QC reports a change in income discovered during the QC review, action should only be taken if the change results in a benefit increase or the income exceeds the gross income limit. Action is not taken if the change would result in decreased benefits. The information is not considered verified upon receipt since additional information would be required.

Clients who fail to cooperate with QC will be referred to the local office in order for the local office to assist in getting the client to cooperate. QC notifies the local office that a client has failed to cooperate with the QC review process by sending the Quality Control Failure to Cooperate Notification ([QC 9FTC](#)). The QC 9FTC informs the local office that QC's attempts to contact/locate the household were unsuccessful and requests assistance in contacting/locating the client.

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Upon receipt of the [QC 9FTC](#), the worker must contact the household by telephone within 5 days and advise the household they must cooperate with QC. If the household cannot be reached by telephone, send a Client Contact Letter ([OFS 18C](#)), advising the household to contact the local office within 10 days to discuss cooperating with the QC review process.

- If the worker speaks to the client or a responsible household member and informs the household of the requirement to cooperate with QC, the worker must complete the “TO BE COMPLETED BY THE PARISH OFFICE” section of the QC 9FTC originally sent by QC. The worker must return the form to the QC reviewer the same day contact is made with the household.
- If the household fails to respond to the OFS 18C request for contact to discuss cooperating with the QC review process, no action is needed. The client’s failure to respond will continue to be considered a failure to cooperate with QC and will not result in case closure.

Quality Control (QC) notifies the local office that a household has refused to cooperate with the QC review process by sending the Quality Control Refusal to Cooperate Notification ([QC 9RTC](#)).

******* The worker must *** take the following actions within two workdays of receiving the QC 9RTC:**

- Send an advance notice of adverse action informing the household their case will be closed unless they cooperate with QC,
- Complete the “TO BE COMPLETED BY THE PARISH OFFICE” section of the QC 9RTC originally sent by QC and return to the QC reviewer the same day the case action is completed,
- **Scan a copy of the completed QC 9RTC to OnBase. ****
- Contact the QC reviewer immediately or before the expiration of the advance notice of adverse action, if during the advance notice of adverse action period, the household indicates willingness to cooperate. If the expiration of the advance notice of adverse action period falls on a weekend or holiday, treat the following workday as the expiration day.

The worker must enter a case note documenting all activities.

Households who refuse to cooperate with QC will be disqualified, resulting in case closure. If QC indicates that the household refused to cooperate and the case is closed for refusal to cooperate with QC, the household may reapply but eligibility cannot be re-established until the member cooperates with the QC reviewer unless the time frame allowed for completion of the QC review has passed.

The time frame allowed for completion of a State QC review is 125 days from the end of the Federal Fiscal Year, which ends on September 30. The time frame allowed for completion of a Federal QC review is 9 months from the end of the Federal Fiscal Year.

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If the case is closed because the household refused to cooperate with the State QC review in one Federal Fiscal Year and the household reapplies after February 2 of the following Federal Fiscal Year, the household may be certified, if all eligibility factors are met, and a referral to the State QC reviewer will not be necessary.

If the case is closed because the household refused to cooperate with the Federal QC review in one Federal Fiscal Year and the household reapplies after June 30 of the following Federal Fiscal Year, the household may be certified, if all eligibility factors are met, and a referral to the Federal QC reviewer will not be necessary.

If a case is closed for refusal to cooperate with QC, and the client reapplies, the worker **MUST** refer the household to the appropriate QC reviewer if the time frame allowed for completion of the review has not passed. If the client subsequently fails to cooperate with QC, the application must be rejected for refusal to cooperate with QC.

Example – State QC reviewer notifies the worker that client refused to cooperate with QC on May 4. If the client reapplies for SNAP before February 2 (125 days from the end of the FFY), the household **MUST** cooperate with the State QC reviewer and meet all eligibility requirements prior to certification. If the client reapplies February 3 or after, the household does not need to cooperate with the State QC reviewer prior to certification.

II. PROCEDURES

THE WORKER MUST:

- INFORM THE HOUSEHOLD IN WRITING OF WHAT THE CLIENT MUST DO OR WHAT INFORMATION IS NEEDED,
- ALLOW AT LEAST 10 DAYS FOR THE CLIENT TO PROVIDE THE INFORMATION OR VERIFICATION OR TO ADVISE THE WORKER THAT HE IS UNABLE TO SECURE THE REQUESTED INFORMATION. IF THE 10TH DAY FALLS ON A WEEKEND OR HOLIDAY, THE DUE DATE BECOMES THE FOLLOWING WORKDAY.

AT CERTIFICATION OR REDETERMINATION, WHEN THERE ARE LESS THAN 10 DAYS LEFT IN THE PROCESSING PERIOD, THE APPLICATION/REDETERMINATION **MUST NOT** BE DENIED ON OR BEFORE THE 30TH DAY FOR FAILURE TO PROVIDE VERIFICATION BUT **MUST** REMAIN IN PENDING/SUSPENDED STATUS. THE APPLICATION/REDETERMINATION **MUST NOT** BE DENIED/CLOSED FOR FAILURE TO PROVIDE VERIFICATION PRIOR TO THE DUE DATE.

- IF PARTIAL VERIFICATION IS PROVIDED, A SECOND REQUEST IS NOT NECESSARY.

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- OFFER ASSISTANCE TO THE CLIENT TO OBTAIN THE NEEDED INFORMATION OR TO IDENTIFY AND SECURE ALTERNATE INFORMATION WHEN THE INFORMATION ORIGINALLY REQUESTED CANNOT BE OBTAINED.

C-1311-SNAP - PR APPLICATIONS

IF THE APPLICANT FAILS TO KEEP HIS SCHEDULED APPLICATION APPOINTMENT, ENTER THE REJECTION CODE FOR FAILURE TO KEEP AN APPOINTMENT USING DISPOSITION REASON 07 AND REJECTION CODE 04 AND DISPOSITION THE CASE ON THE DAY OF THE MISSED INTERVIEW APPOINTMENT. THE NOTICE SUPPRESSION FIELD MUST NOT BE COMPLETED. AN AUTOMATED NOTICE OF MISSED INTERVIEW WILL BE SENT TO THE APPLICANT THE FOLLOWING WORKDAY TO NOTIFY THE APPLICANT THAT THEIR SCHEDULED INTERVIEW APPOINTMENT WAS MISSED AND IT IS THEIR RESPONSIBILITY TO CONTACT THE AGENCY TO SCHEDULE ANOTHER APPOINTMENT TO BE INTERVIEWED. IF THE APPLICANT CONTACTS THE AGENCY DURING THE 30 DAY APPLICATION PERIOD, A SECOND INTERVIEW MUST BE SCHEDULED USING AN [OFS 18C](#). THIS INCLUDES A REQUEST THROUGH THE CUSTOMER SERVICE CENTER ON THE 30TH DAY AFTER THE PARISH OFFICE IS CLOSED. IF NO FURTHER ACTION IS TAKEN, LAMI WILL AUTOMATICALLY REJECT THE CASE ON THE 30th DAY FOLLOWING THE APPLICATION DATE (OR THE FOLLOWING WORKDAY IF THE 30th DAY FALLS ON A WEEKEND OR HOLIDAY) AND CHANGE THE CASE STATUS TO CLOSED.

IF THE APPLICANT FAILS TO RESPOND TO THE REQUEST FOR THE INFORMATION OR VERIFICATION BY THE DUE DATE NOTED ON THE FORM OFS 18C AND DOES NOT REQUEST ADDITIONAL TIME IN WHICH TO FURNISH THE INFORMATION, DENY THE APPLICATION ON THE DAY FOLLOWING THE DUE DATE FOR RECEIPT OF THE INFORMATION.

IF THE CLIENT MISSES THE SCHEDULED APPOINTMENT, OR IF THE APPLICANT FAILS TO PROVIDE ALL INFORMATION NEEDED TO COMPLETE THE APPLICATION BY THE 30th DAY FROM THE ORIGINAL DATE, THE CLIENT MAY REAPPLY WITHIN 30 DAYS AFTER THE DATE OF DENIAL WITHOUT COMPLETING ANOTHER APPLICATION. SEE [C-630-SNAP](#), SECTION C-638-SNAP, FOR FURTHER INFORMATION ON REUSE OF THE APPLICATION.

C-1312-SNAP - PR REDETERMINATIONS

CLOSE THE CASE ON THE LAST WORKDAY OF THE LAST MONTH OF CERTIFICATION IF:

- THE CLIENT FAILS TO KEEP A REDETERMINATION APPOINTMENT WITHOUT GOOD CAUSE AFTER SUBMITTING A TIMELY REAPPLICATION, OR
- THE CLIENT FAILS TO PROVIDE REQUIRED VERIFICATION.

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C-1313-SNAP - PR OTHER ELIGIBILITY REVIEWS

When QC notifies the parish office that the household refused to cooperate with QC, the worker must sanction the household. Sanctions are entered on the Non-Compliance Details screen by selecting “Yes” to the question, “Is anyone in the household currently out of compliance or has ever been out of compliance with program requirements?”. Click the ‘NEXT’ button to navigate to the Non-Compliance – Details screen. On the Non-Compliance –Details screen, the worker selects the ‘Name’ of the Person sanctioned, enters the ‘Start/Change Date, the ‘Reported On’ date, the Non-Compliance Violation Type - ‘SNAP QC’, enters the Non-Compliance Reason - ‘Refused to Cooperate with QC (Federal) or (State)’, enters the ‘Decision Date’, and clicks the ‘ADD Non-Compliance’ button.

When eligibility is run, an automated Notice of Decision (OFS 16) is sent informing the household that their case is closed and unless they cooperate with QC by the expiration of the advance notice of adverse action, their case will remain closed.

If the household reapplies when sanctioned for refusal to cooperate with QC, the worker must send an email to the QC reviewer advising that the client reapplied. If the client subsequently fails to cooperate with QC, the application must be rejected for refusal to cooperate with QC. The sanction/non-compliance should already be entered on the individual household member, therefore when eligibility is run and the case is authorized, an automated OFS 16 will be sent informing the client their application was rejected because they refused to cooperate with QC.

Example – The client refused to cooperate with QC on April 9 and the worker entered the sanction information on the Non-Compliance – Details screen and the case closed effective May. The client reapplied on May 7 and agreed to cooperate with QC. The worker sent an email to the QC reviewer advising the client reapplied. The QC reviewer notified the worker on May 31 that the client refused to cooperate with QC. The application was rejected after eligibility was run using Denial/Closure Reason – Failure due to non-cooperation with Quality Control. An automated OFS 16 was sent to the household informing of the application rejection due to the households’ refusal to cooperate with QC.

III. FORMS AND INSTRUCTIONS

* OFS 016 Form / Instructions Automated Notice of Decision **

OFS 018 [Form](#) / [Instructions](#) Notice of Decision

OFS 018C [Form](#) / [Instructions](#) Client Contact Letter

QC 9FTC [Form](#) / [Instructions](#) Quality Control Failed to Cooperate Notification

QC 9RTC [Form](#) / [Instructions](#) Quality Control Refuse to Cooperate Notification

IV. REFERENCES

[7CFR 273.2\(d\)\(2\)](#)

LAC 67:III Chapter 19